British India. On 12 August 1947, the first thing Janak Singh had to do was to send telegrams to both the emerging dominions of India and Pakistan, proposing parallel standstill agreements with both of them. The telegram sent to the Government of India stated that Jammu and Kashmir would welcome a standstill agreement with the union of India on all matters that presently existed between the state and the outgoing British Indian Government. It suggested that the existing arrangements should continue till the deciding upon and the formal execution of fresh arrangements. These arrangements, according to the Treaty of Amritsar of 1846, comprised the use of Indian forces if there was internal rebellion or invasion by a foreign government.

On 15 August 1947, Pakistan agreed to sign a Standstill Agreement and under this agreement,[4] the Pakistani Government assumed charge of Jammu and Kashmir's postal and telegraph system and also agreed to supply the state with foodstuffs and other essential commodities. However, the Government of India demurred. If the Government of India had signed the standstill agreement, could it have come to the aid of the state without having to use the device of the Instrument of Accession, in case the state faced either an internal rebellion or external? Did Mountbatten cancel the Gilgit lease so it would not endure if the Standstill Agreement had been signed with India, as he expected? Did the loophole of the absence of a standstill agreement with India activate Lord Ismay and his team into action?

We are already aware of the conspiracy behind Datta Khel. Was the invasion of the state by the Pashtun tribesmen on 22 October 1947, under the aegis of Operation Gulmarg, actually the part of a combined plan to invade the state, overthrow its leadership and absorb it into Pakistan by force? For many years, the operations Gulmarg and Datta Khel have been assumed and marketed to be independent and isolated operations. But, it can be argued that parallel coincidences do not exist in reality and that both of these actions were part of the same grand design. While there is no written archival record to substantiate this observation, let us examine the circumstantial arguments and attempt to join the dots.